

Amazfit GTR Mini

Powerful and stylish

G.S. Vasan | vasan@digit.in

Amazfit GTR Mini brings a solid feature set and experience for the price! Well, here is my account —the results and reactions from wearing it for a week; during my workouts, work hours, and weekend outings.

Design

Amazfit GTR Mini looks like a modest and low-rent version of GTR 4, which it is. It sports a round dial and shiny steel-coloured side frame and crown. We will get to the use of the crown in the following segment. But, the whole design is so classic. Likely struck by its look, many asked which smartwatch it is. What isn't classic is the strapping mechanism. Amazfit has imitated the Apple Watch's buckling style. It works fine as long as you don't wrap it tightly around your wrist because then it is a tough task to insert the remaining strap through the slit. This was true for not just me but some of my colleagues who tried wearing it. Rest, the silicone band's light and the whole watch (at 24.6g) is comfy on the wrist for long periods of wearing. The good thing is that the bundled 20mm strap is easily swappable. Personally, I would have loved if Amazfit went with a complete black design sans

the lustrous frame. The touchscreen is Waterproof Enhanced, i.e., it accepts input even when there's water on the screen or your fingertips are moist.

Display and UI

Amazfit GTR Mini has got a 1.28-inch AMOLED panel with a 416x416 resolution. It appears to have an edge-to-edge spread. The screen is fairly bright but I feel the font size and design could have been bigger and more legible. You can always change the watch face. Changing the background reveals that thick border. The margin doesn't get in the way while we interact with the UI. Swiping up on the main screen shows the notification tray and swiping down on the homescreen brings the quick settings menu. Pressing the crown from the homescreen takes you to the app library. Press it from any other screen takes you straight back to the homescreen. Swiping left or right shows the widgets like activity summary, music playback controls, heart rate, sleep, weather, etc.

Performance and Power

The heart rate, SpO2, and step-counting results were comparable to what I got out of an Apple Watch Series 8. You can track more than 120 activity modes and the ones I used the most were Strength

Training, Walking, and Indoor Cycling. When compared to an Apple Watch Series 8 that was tested alongside, the results showed significant deviation in the distance covered during outdoor walk. The reason, I believe, is that the Amazfit watch's GPS locks in a little late and hence, the distance measurement also starts late. However, what's good is that the watch is consistent in its tracking behaviour. So, you can rely on the log to analyze and compare your performance over a period of time. Also, note that GTR Mini comes with built-in continuous GPS functionality powered by 5 stellite positioning systems and the company's patented circularly-polarized GPS antenna technology. During indoor free training, the GTR Mini scored similar results to the Apple Watch in average bpm and calorie consumed. But, it wasn't picking up extreme heart rate counts like the Series 8.

Whence compared to the Apple Watch, the GTR Mini's sleep records were 15 minutes short. It also shows the sleep stages, sleep score, heart rate during the nightly hours, etc. It claims to keep tabs on the naps too. I don't do siesta and so can't verify the same. Finally, as far as battery life is concerned, Amazfit GTR Mini is rated to run 14 days on regular use. In my experience of 7 days, the battery fell up to 50%. Now, unless the battery life dips drastically, I should be getting the claimed endurance out of the watch. Now, if you want to increase the runtime, you can activate the battery saver mode. The claim is that the watch will clock up to 21 days in this mode. Go figure!

What do I think of it?

Amazfit GTR Mini is both powerful and stylish. The health and fitness features work reliably, for the most part. The main exception being the accuracy of the distance tracking. That and the uninspiring strapping system are the only issues I have with it. They aren't deal breaker by any means. I highlight them only because the asking price isn't cheap. But, that's just me. If you feel different or are curious to know about the GTR Mini, check out the watch, you might love it! 

